

Immobilien_AI • Budenfinder

Lean Canvas Business Model • Berlin PropTech Startup • v2.0
Refined Target Audience | April 2026 | Confidential

What is Budenfinder?
Berlin's rental market is one of Europe's most competitive — with a 0.3% vacancy rate and ~250 applicants per listing. Budenfinder is an AI-powered rental platform built specifically for students, expats, and working professionals arriving in or already living in Berlin. It aggregates every available listing into one intelligent feed, matches tenants by budget, lifestyle, and legal rights, and auto-applies on their behalf — making the process faster, safer, and smarter.

The Lean Canvas

BLOCK 1 Problem › Listings scattered across 15+ separate portals in Berlin › Average Berlin rent EUR 15.79/m2 in 2025 — affordability crisis › Students & expats waste 10-20 hrs/week manually searching portals › Non-German speakers face language and navigation barriers › Complex paperwork: SCHUFA, income proof, cover letters overwhelm newcomers › Mietpreisbremse violations rarely flagged — tenants overpay unknowingly › ~250 applicants per listing — newcomers lose out to locals every time	BLOCK 2 Solution › AI scraper aggregates all Berlin portals into 1 unified real-time feed › Personalised questionnaire matches listings to tenant budget & lifestyle › Free tier: full search access based on preferences — zero barrier › Mid tier (EUR 3-5/mo): daily/weekly email alerts for affordable apartments › Pro tier (EUR 6-10/mo): AI auto-applies using uploaded application docs › Automated Mietpreisbremse compliance checker flags illegal rents › ML fraud detection removes scam listings before tenants see them	BLOCK 3 Key Metrics › Monthly Active Users (MAU) and Weekly Active Users (WAU) › Free-to-Mid tier conversion rate (target: 15-20%) › Mid-to-Pro tier conversion rate (target: 8-12%) › AI match accuracy score (target: >90% relevance rating) › Viewings booked per active user per month › Average time-to-find apartment (target: <5 days) › Monthly churn rate (target: <5%) and NPS score › CAC vs. LTV ratio (target: >=3:1)
BLOCK 4 — UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION "Every Rental in Berlin. 1 Intelligence Feed. 1-Click Apply — AI matching your budget, lifestyle, and legal rights. Finding your home faster, safer, and smarter." › Free to search — zero barrier, no credit card, no commitment › EUR 3-5/mo email alerts for cheap, affordable apartments matching your exact profile › EUR 6-10/mo AI auto-applies for you — upload your docs once, apply everywhere › Built specifically for students, expats, and professionals arriving in Berlin › Legal transparency — automatic Mietpreisbremse rent-cap compliance alerts › No more scams — ML-powered fraud detection on every single listing		

BLOCK 5

Unfair Advantage

- › Proprietary Berlin rental corpus — largest aggregated dataset in the city
- › Self-improving AI model: more users = better match accuracy
- › DSGVO (GDPR) compliant by design — builds institutional trust
- › First-mover in AI-native rental aggregation in Berlin
- › University & visa agency partnerships create exclusive distribution
- › Deep integration of German tenancy law (Mietrecht) into the product

BLOCK 6

Go-To-Market & Channels

- › University partnerships: CODE University, BSBI, HU, FU, TU Berlin
- › Visa & immigration agency partnerships for accommodation referrals
- › Instagram & LinkedIn targeted ads for students and professionals
- › Slack communities: expat groups, coding bootcamps, tech hubs
- › Facebook Berlin housing groups — dominant informal search channel
- › Referral programme: earn free Pro months for successful sign-ups
- › SEO: Berlin rental guides, neighbourhood comparisons, tenant rights

BLOCK 7

Customer Segments

- › Students (expat & non-expat): ages 18-28, all genders — CODE, BSBI, HU, FU, TU Berlin
- › Working professionals: incoming & already in Berlin, ages 25-45, all genders
- › International expats: non-German speakers navigating Berlin for the first time
- › Local renters: German-speaking tenants seeking faster, smarter search
- › TAM: ~150,000 active Berlin rental seekers per month
- › SAM (Year 1): ~30,000 students & new professionals

BLOCK 8

Cost Structure

- › Cloud infrastructure (AWS/GCP): ~EUR 3,500/month
- › ML engineering team: 2 engineers + 1 data scientist (EUR 180k-220k/yr)
- › Web scraping API licences & proxy services: ~EUR 800/month
- › Legal and DSGVO compliance counsel: ~EUR 12k/year
- › Product design & frontend development: EUR 60k-80k/year
- › Performance marketing (Instagram, LinkedIn, referrals): EUR 3k-5k/month
- › University & visa agency partnership management: EUR 1k/month

BLOCK 9

Revenue Streams — 3-Tier SaaS

- › FREE: Full apartment search based on preferences & questionnaire — EUR 0
- › MID TIER (EUR 3-5/mo): Daily or weekly email alerts for cheap, affordable apartments
- › PRO TIER (EUR 6-10/mo): AI auto-applies using uploaded application documents
- › Referral commissions: from university, visa agency & relocation partnerships
- › B2B API access: anonymised demand data for landlords, HR teams, city planners
- › Year 1 Revenue Target: EUR 120,000 ARR

Business Model — 3-Tier SaaS

"Free to search. EUR 3-5/mo to get the best deals in your inbox. EUR 6-10/mo to let AI apply for you."

Free Tier

EUR 0 / month

Full search access — no credit card needed

- › Personalised questionnaire to set preferences
- › All Berlin apartments in one unified feed
- › Basic neighbourhood info & map view
- › Mietpreisbremse compliance alerts
- › ML fraud detection on every listing
- › Save favourites & set basic filters

Mid Tier

EUR 3-5 / month

Daily or weekly email alerts for affordable apartments

- › Everything in Free tier
- › Daily or weekly email digest of new cheap apartments
- › Alerts filtered to your exact budget & preferences
- › Priority notifications for new listings
- › Advanced filters: commute time, noise level, pet policy
- › Neighbourhood quality scoring (Kiez Score)

Pro Tier

EUR 6-10 / month

AI auto-applies using your uploaded documents

- › Everything in Mid tier
- › Upload application docs once (SCHUFA, income proof, ID)
- › AI generates personalised cover letter per listing
- › 1-click auto-apply to matching listings
- › Application tracker with full timeline & reminders
- › Rejection analysis: AI explains why + how to fix
- › Tenant profile score with explainability

Unit Economics (100 active users/month): 50 Free users = EUR 0 | 30 Mid Tier x EUR 4 avg = EUR 120 | 20 Pro Tier x EUR 8 avg = EUR 160 | Total MRR = EUR 280 --> EUR 3,360 ARR at 100 users | At 1,000 users: EUR 33,600 ARR | At 10,000 users: EUR 336,000 ARR

Target Audience Deep-Dive

Segment	Profile	Pain Point	Tier Fit
Students (Expat)	Ages 18-28, arriving at CODE, BSBI, HU, FU, TU Berlin	No German, no SCHUFA, no local guarantor — rejected constantly	Free -> Pro
Students (Local)	Ages 18-26, German-speaking, budget-constrained	Too many portals, listings gone within hours of posting	Free -> Mid
Working Professionals (Incoming)	Ages 25-45, relocating for job offer, all genders	No time to search, need apartment before start date	Mid -> Pro
Working Professionals (In Berlin)	Ages 25-45, already in Berlin, upgrading apartment	Competitive market, losing out to faster applicants	Mid -> Pro
International Expats	Non-German speakers, any age, new to Berlin	Language barrier, unfamiliar with German rental law & process	Free -> Pro
Local Renters	German-speaking, any age, want smarter search	Fragmented portals, time-consuming manual process	Free -> Mid

Go-To-Market Strategy

Channel	Target	Tactic	Expected Reach
CODE University & BSBI	International students	Partnership: welcome pack, orientation events, email list	~2,000 students/yr

Channel	Target	Tactic	Expected Reach
HU, FU, TU Berlin	Domestic & expat students	International office partnerships, student union ads	~200,000 students
Visa & Immigration Agencies	New expats arriving in Berlin	Accommodation referral at point of visa approval	~50,000 expats/yr
Instagram Ads	Students & young professionals	Targeted ads: 'Moving to Berlin?' creative campaigns	~500k impressions/mo
LinkedIn Ads	Working professionals	Targeted by job title + location: relocating to Berlin	~100k impressions/mo
Slack Communities	Tech expats, bootcamp grads	Presence in Berlin expat, tech, and startup Slack groups	~20,000 members
Referral Programme	All users	Free Pro month for every successful referral sign-up	Viral K-factor >1
SEO Content	Organic search	Berlin rental guides, Mietpreisbremse explainers, neighbourhood guides	~10k visits/mo (Yr 1)

Berlin Rental Market — Key Data Points

0.3% Vacancy rate in Berlin 2025	~250 Applicants per listing on average	EUR 15.79 Avg rent/m2/month Berlin 2025	150k Active rental seekers per month in Berlin	85% Berlin residents who rent vs. own	15+ Fragmented portals tenants search manually
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Budenfinder vs. ImmobilienScout24

Feature	ImmobilienScout24	Budenfinder
Multi-source listing aggregation	Own listings only	All Berlin portals scraped
Pricing model	Free + premium EUR 19.95/mo	Free / EUR 3-5 / EUR 6-10
AI cover letter generation	Not available	Listing-specific, personalised
1-click AI auto-apply	Not available	Upload once, apply everywhere
Daily email alerts for cheap flats	Not available	Mid tier feature (EUR 3-5/mo)
Tenant profile score	Not available	Explainable AI score
Application tracker	Not available	Full timeline + reminders
Rejection analysis	Not available	AI explains why + how to fix
Mietpreisbremse checker	Not available	Automated compliance flag
Expat / student onboarding	German-first UX	English-first, multilingual
Fraud detection	Basic	ML-powered on every listing

References & Sources

Berlin Mietspiegel 2023 — Official Rent Index Official Berlin rent index for Mietpreisbremse compliance checks. https://www.berlin.de/sen/wohnen/service/mietspiegel/	CODE University of Applied Sciences Berlin Private university — key student partnership target for Budenfinder. https://code.berlin/
Berlin School of Business & Innovation (BSBI) Private university — key student partnership target for Budenfinder. https://bsbi.de/	WG-Gesucht — Berlin Rental Data 16.98M visits/month; dominant platform for shared apartments in Berlin. https://www.wg-gesucht.de/
ImmobilienScout24 — Market Reports Germany's largest property portal; key competitor and market data source. https://www.immobilienscout24.de/	EXIST Grunderstipendium — Federal Startup Grant German federal grant programme for tech startups — up to EUR 150,000. https://www.exist.de/

Mietpreisbremse — German Rent Brake Law Federal law capping rent increases; core compliance feature of Budenfinder. https://www.bmj.de/DE/themen/mietrecht/mietpreisbremse/	Berlin Senate Department for Housing Official source for Berlin housing policy, vacancy data, and tenant rights. https://www.berlin.de/sen/wohnen/
HousingAnywhere — Berlin Listings International rental platform; competitor with 25-40% booking fee model. https://housinganywhere.com/	PropTech Germany Association Industry body for German property technology startups and ecosystem. https://www.proptech-germany.de/